
Errington, BC · Zone 8a · Central Vancouver Island

ERRINGTON, BC

ZONE 8a PLANTING

CALENDAR

Central Vancouver Island · A Complete Guide for Edible Crops & Ornamentals



Climate Summary — Zone 8a

Zone

Last Frost

First Frost

Frost-Free Days

Annual Rainfall

Winter Low

8a

~April 15

~October 15

~183 days

~1,200 mm

Rarely below -12°C

Mild maritime winters · Summer dry spells July–August · Long daylight summers ideal for warm-season crops

How to Use This Calendar

Each month is presented as a **two-page spread**. **Page A** covers **edible crops** (vegetables, fruits, herbs, grains, legumes, roots & tubers, and perennial edibles). **Page B** covers **flowers & ornamentals** (annuals, perennials, bulbs, shrubs, vines, BC natives, and cut flowers). All timing is calibrated to **Errington, BC (Zone 8a)**, central Vancouver Island. Frost-date markers appear on months with frost risk. *Always harden off transplants for 7–10 days before planting outdoors.*

Full Icon Legend



Indoor Sow

— Start seeds under lights indoors



Direct Sow Outdoors

— Sow directly into garden soil



Transplant

— Move starts from indoors to garden



Harvest

— Crop is ready to pick



Bloom

— Plant is in flower



Frost Risk

— Protect tender plants; frost possible



Prune / Deadhead

— Cut back for health or more blooms



Plant Bulb / Tuber

— Plant underground storage organs



Overwinter / Mulch

— Protect crowns with straw or mulch

Important Note

Frost-date markers appear on every monthly page from **October through April**. Always harden off transplants for **7-10 days** before planting outdoors. Use cloches, row cover, or cold frames to extend the season at both ends. All dates are approximate — observe your local microclimate, especially if your garden is sheltered or exposed to sea breezes.



FROST RISK — January is fully within the frost season. Protect all tender plants.
Hard frosts possible. Mulch overwintering crops.

JANUARY

PAGE A · EDIBLE CROPS

VEGETABLES

Crop	Indoor Sow	Direct Sow / Transplant	Harvest / Action
Seed & Crop Planning	—	—	Order seed catalogues; plan rotations
Garlic (overwintering)	—	—	* Mulch in place; overwintering
Kale (overwintered)	—	—	Light harvest if protected
Chard (overwintered)	—	—	Light harvest if protected *
Stored Squash / Roots	—	—	Check cold storage; remove any rot

HERBS

Herb	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Rosemary	Wk 3-4 (under lights)	—	—
Thyme	Wk 3-4 (under lights)	—	—
Oregano	Wk 3-4 (under lights)	—	—

FRUITS & BERRIES

Fruit	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Apple / Pear / Plum / Cherry	—	—	✂ Prune dormant trees Jan-Feb
Bare-root fruit stock	—	—	Order from nursery now

ROOTS & TUBERS

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Potatoes / Carrots / Beets	—	—	Check cold storage; remove rot

LEGUMES & GRAINS

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
All legumes & grains	—	—	Nothing this month; plan rotations

PERENNIAL EDIBLES

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Rhubarb	—	—	Fully dormant *
Asparagus	—	—	Fully dormant *

 **January Monthly Tips**

- ✓ Order seed catalogues now for best variety selection — popular varieties sell out by February.
- ✓ Clean and sterilize seed trays with diluted bleach solution; rinse and dry thoroughly before spring use.
- ✓ Sharpen and oil all pruning tools. Set up grow-light stations for the busy sowing months ahead.

LEGEND:



Indoor Sow



Direct Sow Outdoors



Transplant



Harvest



Bloom





Frost Risk



Prune/Deadhead



Plant Bulb/Tuber



Overwinter/Mulch

Errington, BC · Zone 8a · Central Vancouver Island

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FROST RISK — January. Frost likely most nights. Protect containers; bring tender plants indoors. Forced bulbs safe indoors.

JANUARY

PAGE B · FLOWERS & ORNAMENTALS

ANNUAL FLOWERS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Snapdragons	Late Jan (under lights)	—	—
Petunias	Late Jan (under lights)	—	—
Lobelia	Late Jan (under lights)	—	—

HARDY PERENNIALS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Hellebores (Lenten Rose)	—	—	 Blooming outdoors; cut tatty foliage
Snowdrops (Galanthus)	—	—	 Blooming; divide after bloom if congested

BULBS & CORMS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Snowdrops (Galanthus)	—	—	 Blooming outdoors ❄️
Forced bulbs (indoors)	—	—	 Check for growth; keep in bright spot

SHRUBS & TREES (Ornamental)

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Witch Hazel (Hamamelis)	—	—	 Blooming — fragrant winter display
Buddleja / Hydrangea paniculata	—	—	 Prune hard Jan-Feb

CLIMBING VINES

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Wisteria	—	—	✂ Prune summer shoots to 2-3 buds

BC NATIVE PLANTS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Osoberry (Oemleria)	—	—	Buds beginning to swell; earliest native

CUT FLOWERS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Amaryllis (forced, indoors)	—	—	 Blooming indoors; stake tall stems
Paperwhite Narcissus (forced)	—	—	 Blooming indoors — fragrant

January Monthly Tips

- ✓ Check stored dahlia and canna tubers for rot — discard any soft or mouldy sections immediately.
- ✓ Begin cleaning garden beds during mild spells. Apply compost as a winter mulch to borders.

LEGEND:



Indoor Sow

|



Direct Sow Outdoors

|



Transplant



Harvest



Bloom



Frost Risk



Prune/Deadhead



Plant Bulb/Tuber



Overwinter/Mulch



FROST RISK — February. Frosts still likely most nights. Soil mostly cold. Grow lights essential for indoor sowings.

FEBRUARY

PAGE A · EDIBLE CROPS

VEGETABLES

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Celery / Celeriac	Wk 1 (16 wks to transplant)	—	—
Leeks	Wk 1-2	—	—
Onions	Wk 2-4	—	—
Peppers (early)	Wk 3-4	—	—
Eggplant (early)	Wk 4	—	—
Kale / Chard (overwintered)	—	—	 Light harvest if not frozen ❄️

HERBS

Herb	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Parsley	Wk 1-2 (slow germinator)	—	—
Chives	Wk 1-2	—	—
Basil	Wk 4 (under lights, warm)	—	—

FRUITS & BERRIES

Fruit	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Apple / Pear / Plum / Cherry	—	—	✂ Prune before bud break (Feb)
Grape vines	—	—	✂ Prune Feb — before sap rises
Strawberries (bare-root)	—	 Late Feb if ground workable	—

ROOTS & TUBERS

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
All root crops	—	—	Too early to sow. Check cold storage.

LEGUMES & GRAINS

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
All legumes & grains	—	—	Nothing this month

PERENNIAL EDIBLES

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Globe Artichoke	Wk 3-4 (needs vernalisation)	—	—
Rhubarb	—	—	Crown tips may appear — leave
Asparagus	—	—	Still dormant ✱

February Monthly Tips

- ✓ Set up grow lights — 14-16 hrs/day, 5-10cm above seedlings. Maintain 18-21°C for germination.

✓ Hardening off is not yet needed — keep all seedlings indoors in warmth this month.

LEGEND:



Indoor Sow

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Direct Sow Outdoors

|



→



Transplant

|



Harvest

|



Bloom

|



Frost Risk

|



Prune/Deadhead

|



Plant Bulb/Tuber

|



Overwinter/Mulch

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FROST RISK — February. Nights still frosty. First spring bulbs braving the cold.
Indoor seed starting begins in earnest.

FEBRUARY

PAGE B · FLOWERS & ORNAMENTALS

ANNUAL FLOWERS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Snapdragon	Wk 1	—	—
Lobelia	Wk 1-2	—	—
Pansy	Wk 1-2	—	—
Stocks (Matthiola)	Wk 2	—	—
Statice	Wk 2	—	—
Antirrhinum	Wk 2	—	—

HARDY PERENNIALS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Delphinium	Wk 1	—	—
Echinacea (Coneflower)	Wk 2	—	—
Salvia nemorosa	Wk 2	—	—
Hellebores	—	—	 Peak bloom outdoors
Snowdrops	—	Divide "in the green" now	 Blooming — divide congested clumps

BULBS & CORMS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Anemone corms	—	 Plant outdoors (if not frozen)	—
Snowdrops / early Crocus	—	—	 Blooming ✨

SHRUBS & TREES (Ornamental)

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Witch Hazel (Hamamelis)	—	—	 Blooming — fragrant in mild spells
Roses	—	—	✂️ Light prune late Feb
Forsythia	—	—	Buds swelling; bloom imminent

CLIMBING VINES

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Group 3 Clematis	—	—	✂ Prune hard to 30cm late Feb-Mar
Clematis montana	—	—	Do NOT prune — prune after bloom

BC NATIVE PLANTS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Indian Plum (Oemleria)	—	—	 Earliest native in bloom
Red Flowering Currant (Ribes)	—	—	Buds swelling — bloom coming soon

CUT FLOWERS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Lisianthus	Wk 1 (16-20 wks to bloom)	—	—
Statice	Wk 2	—	—

February Monthly Tips

- ✓ Clean up dead perennial foliage now to prevent slug habitat. Top-dress beds with compost or well-rotted manure.
- ✓ Divide snowdrops while still "in the green" — they establish far better than dry bulbs.

LEGEND:



Indoor Sow

|



Direct Sow Outdoors



Transplant



Harvest



Bloom



Frost Risk



Prune/Deadhead



Plant Bulb/Tuber





Overwinter/Mulch

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FROST RISK — March. Frosts still common especially at night. Use cloches and row cover for all outdoor sowings.

MARCH

PAGE A · EDIBLE CROPS

VEGETABLES

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Tomatoes	Wk 1-2 (8-10 wks before transplant)	—	—
Peppers / Eggplant	Continue from Feb	—	—
Broccoli / Cauliflower / Cabbage	Wk 1	—	—
Brussels Sprouts	Wk 1-2	—	—
Kale (new crop)	Wk 1-2	—	—
Lettuce / Spinach	Wk 1 (indoors)	 Wk 3-4 under cloche *  Wk 3-4 (cold-tolerant)	—
Peas	—	*  Wk 3-4 *	—
Broad Beans (Fava)	—	 Wk 3-4 (under fleece)	—

HERBS

Herb	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Basil	Wk 1-2 (indoors only)	—	—
Dill	Wk 1-2	 Late Mar direct sow OK	—
Cilantro	—	 Direct sow late Mar	—

FRUITS & BERRIES

Fruit	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Strawberries (from seed)	Wk 1 (long season needed)	—	—
Strawberries / Currants / Gooseberries (bare-root)	—	 Mar if ground workable	—
Blueberries	—	—	✂ Prune Mar; apply dormant spray
Apple / Pear / Cherry	—	—	Apply dormant oil spray now

ROOTS & TUBERS

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Parsnips	—	 Wk 3-4 (needs warm soil)	—
Carrots	—	 Wk 3-4 under fleece	—
Seed Potatoes	Chit indoors in light (Mar)	—	—

LEGUMES

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Peas	—	 Wk 3-4 outdoors ✱	—
Broad Beans (Fava)	—	 Wk 3-4 ✱	—

PERENNIAL EDIBLES

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Globe Artichoke	Continue from Feb	—	—
Asparagus crowns	—	Plant late Mar (if workable)	—
Rhubarb	—	—	Emerging — do not harvest 1st yr

March Monthly Tips

- ✓ Do NOT harden off seedlings yet — frosts are still likely most nights. Use cloches or row cover for all outdoor sowings.
- ✓ Chit seed potatoes in a bright, frost-free location indoors to get a 2–3 week head start before planting in April.

LEGEND:



Indoor Sow

|



Direct Sow Outdoors

|



→



Transplant

|



Harvest



Bloom



Frost Risk



Prune/Deadhead



Plant Bulb/Tuber



Overwinter/Mulch

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FROST RISK — March. Nights still frosty but garden waking fast. Spring bulb peak.
Do not move tender plants outdoors.

MARCH

PAGE B • FLOWERS & ORNAMENTALS

ANNUAL FLOWERS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Impatiens	Wk 1	—	—
Nicotiana / Cleome	Wk 1	—	—
Marigold	Wk 2	—	—
Zinnia / Cosmos	Wk 3	—	—
Sweet Peas	—	 Direct sow outdoors Wk 3-4	—

HARDY PERENNIALS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Coneflower / Rudbeckia	Wk 1	—	—
Gaillardia	Wk 2	—	—
Larkspur / Poppy	—	 Direct sow Wk 3-4	—
Hostas / Daylilies / Asters	—	Divide emerging clumps 	Emerging from ground

BULBS & CORMS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Dahlia tubers	 Pot up indoors Wk 3-4	—	—
Daffodils / Crocus / early Tulips	—	—	 Blooming — peak spring display

SHRUBS & TREES (Ornamental)

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Forsythia / Pieris	—	—	 Blooming
Summer-flowering shrubs	—	—	 Prune Mar; feed roses

CLIMBING VINES

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Morning Glory	Wk 3 (indoors)	—	—
Group 3 Clematis	—	—	 Prune hard early Mar if not done

BC NATIVE PLANTS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Red Flowering Currant (Ribes)	—	—	 Blooming — hummingbird magnet
Osoberry / Trillium	—	—	 Emerging — do not pick Trillium

CUT FLOWERS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Celosia / Strawflower / Scabiosa	Wk 1-2	—	—
Larkspur	—	 Direct sow outdoors	—

March Monthly Tips

- ✓ Divide snowdrops now "in the green" — far more successful than planting dry bulbs in autumn.
- ✓ Begin weeding as soil warms. Target chickweed, bittercress, and hairy bittercress before they set seed.

LEGEND:



Indoor Sow



Direct Sow Outdoors



Transplant



Harvest



Bloom



Frost Risk





Prune/Deadhead



Plant Bulb/Tuber



Overwinter/Mulch

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LAST FROST ~APRIL 15 — Caution with transplants until after mid-April. Use cloches for early plantings. Frost risk drops sharply after April 15.

APRIL

PAGE A · EDIBLE CROPS

VEGETABLES

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Cucumber	Wk 2-3	—	—
Squash / Zucchini	Wk 2-3	—	—
Melon	Wk 3-4	—	—
Lettuce / Spinach / Arugula	—	 Wk 1-2 outdoors	—
Radish / Beets / Chard	—	 Wk 2-4	—
Carrots / Turnips / Kohlrabi	—	 Wk 2-4	—
Onion sets / Leek starts	—	 →  Wk 3-4	—
Broccoli / Cabbage starts	—	 →  Wk 1-2 (protected); Wk 3-4 (open)	—

HERBS

Herb	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Dill / Cilantro / Chervil / Fennel	—	 Direct sow Wk 3-4	—
Chives / Parsley (starts)	—	 →  Transplant Wk 3-4	—

FRUITS & BERRIES

Fruit	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Strawberry runners	—	 Plant outdoors Wk 3-4	—
Raspberries	—	—	 Cut back old canes
Blueberries / Currants	—	—	New growth beginning; feed now

ROOTS & TUBERS

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Seed potatoes	—	 Plant Wk 3-4 (after last frost)	—
Carrots / Beets (succession)	—	 Direct sow Wk 3-4	—

LEGUMES & GRAINS

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Peas / Broad Beans	—	 Continue outdoor sowing	—
Oats / Spring Wheat	—	 Direct sow Wk 3-4	—

PERENNIAL EDIBLES

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Asparagus	—	—	 Harvest begins Wk 3-4
Rhubarb	—	—	 Harvest begins Wk 3-4
Artichoke	—	 →  Transplant outdoors late Apr	—

April Monthly Tips

- ✓ After April 15 the last-frost risk drops sharply. Begin hardening off tomatoes and peppers — 7-10 days of outdoor exposure before transplanting.
- ✓ Use cloches for early brassica transplants (Wk 1-2) and remove once temperatures are reliably above 5°C overnight.

LEGEND:



Indoor Sow

|



Direct Sow Outdoors

|



→



Transplant



Harvest



Bloom



Frost Risk



Prune/Deadhead



Plant Bulb/Tuber



Overwinter/Mulch



FROST RISK — April. Last frost ~April 15. Hold frost-tender transplants until after mid-month. Spring bulbs at peak.

APRIL

PAGE B • FLOWERS & ORNAMENTALS

ANNUAL FLOWERS

Plant	Indoor Sow	Direct Sow / Transplant	Bloom / Action
Snapdragons / Pansies / Stocks	—	Transplant cold-tolerant after Apr 15	—
Sweet Peas	—	Direct sow Wk 1-2	—
Larkspur / Poppy / Nigella / Calendula / Borage	—	Direct sow Wk 2-4	—

HARDY PERENNIALS

Plant	Indoor Sow	Direct Sow / Transplant	Bloom / Action
Primula / Wallflower / Aubretia / Iberis	—	—	Blooming
Perennial seedlings (hardened-off)	—	Transplant Wk 3-4	—
Hostas / Daylilies / Asters	—	Divide established clumps ✂	—

BULBS & CORMS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Tulips / Daffodils / Hyacinths / Muscari / Allium	—	—	 Peak spring bulb display
Dahlia tubers	—	 Plant outdoors after Apr 15	—
Gladiolus corms	—	 Plant Wk 3-4	—

SHRUBS & TREES (Ornamental)

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Magnolia / Camellia / Rhododendron / Azalea	—	—	 Stunning spring display
Spring-flowering shrubs (Forsythia, Kerria)	—	—	 Prune AFTER bloom; feed roses

CLIMBING VINES

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Sweet Peas	—	 →  Transplant outdoors Wk 3-4	—
Morning Glory	—	Wait until May	—
Honeysuckle	—	—	Leafing out; new growth vigorous

BC NATIVE PLANTS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Bleeding Heart (Dicentra) / Pacific Trillium	—	—	 Blooming in shaded spots
Camas (Camassia)	—	—	 Beginning to bloom
Garry Oak	—	—	Leafing out; catkins dropping

CUT FLOWERS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Cornflower / Ammi majus / Orlaya	—	 Direct sow Wk 2-4	—
Lisianthus / Snapdragon (starts)	—	 →  Transplant late Apr	—


April Monthly Tips

- ✓ Top-dress beds with compost before planting — do not dig in; let worms work it down.
- ✓ Deadhead spring bulbs after bloom but leave foliage for 6 weeks — it feeds next year's bulb.

LEGEND:



Indoor Sow

|



Direct Sow Outdoors

|



→



Transplant

|



Harvest

|



Bloom



Frost Risk



Prune/Deadhead



Plant Bulb/Tuber



Overwinter/Mulch

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MAY

PAGE A · EDIBLE CROPS

VEGETABLES

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Tomatoes	—	  Transplant Wk 1-2 (hardened)	—
Peppers / Eggplant	—	  Transplant Wk 1-2	—
Cucumber / Zucchini / Squash	—	  Transplant Wk 2-3	—
Beans (French / Runner)	—	 Direct sow Wk 2-4	—
Corn	—	 Direct sow Wk 3-4	—
Beets / Carrots / Lettuce / Chard / Kale	—	 Succession sow Wk 1-4	—
Peas (second sowing)	—	 Wk 1-2 for late crop	—

HERBS

Herb	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Basil	—	  Transplant Wk 2 (soil must be warm)	—
Rosemary / Thyme / Oregano	—	  Transplant now	—
Dill / Cilantro / Fennel	—	 Succession direct sow	—

FRUITS & BERRIES

Fruit	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Strawberries	—	—	 Flowers forming; remove 1st-yr runners' flowers
Blueberries / Gooseberries	—	—	 Flowering; set fruit
Apple / Pear	—	—	Thin fruitlets late May (June drop)

ROOTS & TUBERS

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Carrots / Beets / Parsnips	—	 Succession sow	—
Sweet potato slips	—	 Plant late May (soil warm)	—

LEGUMES & GRAINS

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Beans (French / Runner) / Edamame	—	 Direct sow Wk 2-4	—
Broad Beans	—	—	 In flower — pinch tops to deter blackfly
Corn / Sunflower	—	 Direct sow Wk 3-4	—

PERENNIAL EDIBLES

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Asparagus	—	—	 Full harvest — pick daily
Rhubarb	—	—	 Harvest stalks; leave some leaves
Artichoke	—	—	Establishing in garden

May Monthly Tips

- ✓ Stake tomatoes and tall crops at transplant time — it is far easier than staking into established roots later.
- ✓ Mulch around all transplants with 5-7cm of straw or compost to conserve moisture through the dry summer ahead.

LEGEND:



Indoor Sow

|



Direct Sow Outdoors

|



Transplant

|



Harvest

|



Bloom

|



Frost Risk

|



Prune/Deadhead

|



Plant Bulb/Tuber

|



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MAY

PAGE B · FLOWERS & ORNAMENTALS

ANNUAL FLOWERS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Impatiens / Marigolds / Petunias / Begonias	—	  All frost-tender annuals outdoors Wk 1-2	—
Zinnias / Cosmos / Nicotiana / Cleome	—	  Transplant Wk 1-2	—
Zinnia / Cosmos / Nasturtium / Sunflower / Morning Glory / Borage	—	 Direct sow Wk 1-3	—

HARDY PERENNIALS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Aquilegia / Geranium / Lupine / Iris	—	—	 Blooming — peak early perennials
Allium / Centaurea	—	—	 Beginning to bloom
Late-emerging perennials	—	Divide early May 	—

BULBS & CORMS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Late Tulips / Allium / Camassia	—	—	 Blooming
Dahlia tubers	—	 Plant now if not done	—
Gladiolus (succession)	—	 Plant every 2 wks for staggered bloom	—

SHRUBS & TREES (Ornamental)

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Rhododendron / Azalea / Lilac / Ceanothus / Weigela	—	—	 Spectacular blooms
Forsythia / Kerria / Ribes (spring-blooming)	—	—	 Prune after bloom finishes

CLIMBING VINES

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Morning Glory / Cobaea scandens	—	 →  Transplant outdoors now	—
Clematis montana	—	—	 Peak bloom — glorious
Honeysuckle	—	—	In bud; bloom imminent

BC NATIVE PLANTS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Camas / Bleeding Heart / Nootka Rose / Bunchberry	—	—	 Blooming — peak native season

CUT FLOWERS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Sunflower	—	 Direct sow Wk 1-2	—
Sweet Peas / Allium / Iris / Aquilegia	—	—	 Excellent for cutting

 May Monthly Tips

- ✓ Pinch Dahlias, Cosmos, and Zinnias when 20–30cm tall for bushier plants with more blooms.
- ✓ Keep deadheading spring bulb flowers but leave all foliage — never tie or cut leaves until fully yellow.

LEGEND:



Indoor Sow



Direct Sow Outdoors



Transplant



Harvest



Bloom

|



Frost Risk

|



Prune/Deadhead

|



Plant Bulb/Tuber

|



Overwinter/Mulch

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JUNE

PAGE A · EDIBLE CROPS

VEGETABLES

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Lettuce / Arugula / Radish (succession)	—	 Succession sow Wk 1-4	 Harvest early sowings
Beets / Carrots / Beans / Chard	—	 Succession sow	 Harvest early radish, spinach
Broccoli side shoots	—	—	 Harvest side shoots continuously
Early Peas	—	—	 First pick late June
Broad Beans	—	—	 Harvest late June

HERBS

Herb	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Chives / Parsley / Dill / Chervil	—	—	 Harvest freely; dry or freeze surplus
Cilantro (before bolt)	—	—	 Harvest now — bolts fast in heat
Basil	—	—	 Pinch flowers to prolong leaf harvest

FRUITS & BERRIES

Fruit	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Strawberries	—	—	 Full harvest Wk 1-4
Gooseberries	—	—	 Ready late June
Apple / Pear	—	—	Thin clusters to 1 fruit per spur

ROOTS & TUBERS

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Carrots / Beets (last sow for fall)	—	 Last main sow Wk 1-2	—
Early new potatoes	—	—	 Check Wk 3-4 if planted late March

LEGUMES & GRAINS

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Peas / Beans	—	—	 Peas: first pick late June; beans growing
Corn / Sunflower	—	—	Establishing strongly

PERENNIAL EDIBLES

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Asparagus	—	—	⌘ Stop harvesting Wk 1-2; allow fern growth
Rhubarb	—	—	 Last harvest Wk 1-2; leave plant to rest
Artichoke	—	—	Buds forming late June

June Monthly Tips

- ✓ Water deeply 2x per week during dry spells — deep watering encourages deep roots. Shallow daily watering creates weak plants.
- ✓ Mulch 7-10cm around all vegetables to suppress weeds and conserve summer moisture. Watch for aphids on brassicas and beans.

LEGEND:



Indoor Sow

|



Direct Sow Outdoors

|



→



Transplant



Harvest



Bloom



Frost Risk



Prune/Deadhead



Plant Bulb/Tuber



Overwinter/Mulch

JUNE

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ANNUAL FLOWERS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Marigold / Lobelia / Petunia / Snapdragon	—	—	 First annuals blooming
Nasturtium / Cosmos / Zinnia (early vars.)	—	—	 Beginning to bloom; deadhead ☞

HARDY PERENNIALS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Lupine / Iris / Salvia nemorosa / Allium	—	—	 Peak early summer perennials
Foxglove (Digitalis) / Veronica / Astrantia	—	—	 Blooming beautifully
Achillea (Yarrow)	—	—	 Beginning; excellent pollinator plant
Geranium (Cranesbill)	—	—	 Full bloom; cut back after for rebloom

BULBS & CORMS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Allium / late Iris / first Lily buds	—	—	 Blooming; stake tall Allium
Gladiolus	—	—	Growing strongly; stake tall varieties

SHRUBS & TREES (Ornamental)

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Roses (first flush) / Philadelphia / Weigela / Escallonia	—	—	 Peak first flush — glorious
Philadelphia / Weigela	—	—	 Prune after bloom finishes (late June)

CLIMBING VINES

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Honeysuckle / Clematis 'Nelly Moser' type / Sweet Peas	—	—	 Peak — harvest Sweet Peas daily
Morning Glory	—	—	Climbing and budding

BC NATIVE PLANTS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Nootka Rose / Ocean Spray (Holodiscus)	—	—	 Blooming — excellent for pollinators
Yarrow / Blue-eyed Grass (Sisyrinchium)	—	—	 Blooming in meadow areas

CUT FLOWERS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Allium / Iris / Sweet Pea / Lupine / Foxglove / Salvia	—	—	 Excellent cutting; harvest in morning

June Monthly Tips

- ✓ Feed container plants weekly with liquid fertiliser — pots dry out fast and nutrients wash through

quickly.

✓ Deadhead all spent blooms regularly — this is the single most effective way to extend flowering season.

LEGEND:



Indoor Sow



Direct Sow Outdoors



Transplant



Harvest



Bloom



Frost Risk

|



Prune/Deadhead

|



Plant Bulb/Tuber

|



Overwinter/Mulch

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JULY

PAGE A · EDIBLE CROPS

VEGETABLES

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Beans (for fall) / Lettuce (bolt-resistant)	—	 Succession Wk 1-2 only	—
Beets / Carrots / Kale / Chard	—	 Wk 1-2 (last chance for Kale/Chard)	—
Peas / Beans / Zucchini / Cucumber	—	—	 Full harvest swing

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Tomatoes (early vars.) / Corn (late July)	—	—	 First tomatoes late July
Chard / Kale / Lettuce / Beets / Carrots	—	—	 Harvesting continuously
Cabbage / Broccoli side shoots	—	—	 Ongoing harvest

HERBS

Herb	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Basil / Dill / Cilantro / Parsley / Thyme / Oregano / Mint	—	—	 Full harvest; dry and freeze surplus
Basil	—	—	 Pinch flowers continuously to prevent bolt

FRUITS & BERRIES

Fruit	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Blueberries (mid-July onward)	—	—	 Peak harvest; pick daily
Raspberries (summer-bearing)	—	—	 Harvest; remove fruited canes after
Red / White Currants / Gooseberries	—	—	 Harvest and preserve
Early Plums / Tayberry / Everbearing Strawberries	—	—	 Beginning to fruit

ROOTS & TUBERS

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Carrots / Beets / Turnips	—	 Last chance Wk 1 only	 Harvest new potatoes
Main-crop potatoes	—	—	 Lift as tops die back

LEGUMES & GRAINS

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Beans / Peas	—	—	 Full harvest; pick every 2 days
Edamame	—	—	Developing; harvest when pods plump
Sunflower / Corn	—	—	Sunflower heads forming; corn silking late July

PERENNIAL EDIBLES

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Artichoke	—	—	 Harvest heads before fully open
Rhubarb / Asparagus	—	—	Do NOT harvest; let plants build energy

July Monthly Tips

- ✓ Water every 2-3 days in the dry Errington summer. Side-dress tomatoes, corn, and squash with compost or balanced fertiliser.
- ✓ Pinch out lateral (side) shoots on cordon (indeterminate) tomatoes weekly — this directs energy to fruit production.

LEGEND:



Indoor Sow

|



Direct Sow Outdoors

|





Transplant



Harvest



Bloom



Frost Risk



Prune/Deadhead



Plant Bulb/Tuber



Overwinter/Mulch

JULY

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ANNUAL FLOWERS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Zinnia / Cosmos / Marigold / Cleome / Nicotiana	—	—	 Full peak bloom; deadhead daily ∞
Sweet Pea	—	—	 Peak — harvest every day to extend
Nasturtium / Calendula (for fall)	—	 Last sow Wk 1	 Blooming continuously

HARDY PERENNIALS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Daylily / Echinacea / Rudbeckia / Monarda	—	—	 Peak midsummer perennials
Agapanthus / Veronicastrum / Penstemon / Shasta Daisy	—	—	 Blooming — pollinator paradise
Achillea / Kniphofia (Red Hot Poker)	—	—	 Peak; deadhead ∞ to extend

BULBS & CORMS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Oriental / Asiatic Lilies / Gladiolus	—	—	 Blooming; stake tall varieties
Dahlia (early varieties)	—	—	 First dahlias opening

SHRUBS & TREES (Ornamental)

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Roses (repeat flush) / Lavender / Hydrangea macrophylla	—	—	 Stunning summer display
Roses	—	—	⌘ Deadhead continuously for repeat bloom
Lavender	—	—	⌘ Prune lightly after first flush Wk 2-3

CLIMBING VINES

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Morning Glory / Clematis viticella / Honeysuckle	—	—	 All in gorgeous bloom
Cobaea scandens	—	—	 Cup-and-saucer vine blooming

BC NATIVE PLANTS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Ocean Spray / Yarrow / Spirea douglasii / Fireweed	—	—	 BC summer natives at their best
Pearly Everlasting (Anaphalis)	—	—	 Beginning — excellent for drying

CUT FLOWERS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Zinnia / Cosmos / Sunflower / Dahlia / Lily / Echinacea / Rudbeckia / Sweet Pea / Lavender	—	—	 Best cutting month of the year; harvest in morning

💡 July Monthly Tips

- ✓ Holiday / drought care: mulch deeply to 10cm, water at roots (not foliage), and water in the early morning to reduce evaporation.
- ✓ Avoid wetting foliage in the evening — this promotes fungal disease (powdery mildew, blackspot).

LEGEND:



Indoor Sow



Direct Sow Outdoors



Transplant



Harvest



Bloom

|



Frost Risk

|



Prune/Deadhead

|



Plant Bulb/Tuber

|



Overwinter/Mulch

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AUGUST

PAGE A · EDIBLE CROPS

VEGETABLES

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Broccoli / Kale / Pak Choi (for fall)	Wk 1 under cover	—	—
Spinach / Lettuce (for fall)	Wk 1-3 indoors	 Arugula direct sow Wk 2-4	—
Cilantro (fall)	—	 Direct sow Wk 2-3	—
Tomatoes / Peppers / Corn	—	—	 Peak harvest
Zucchini / Cucumbers / Beans / Eggplant	—	—	 Pick every 2 days; continuous harvest
Melons / Beets / Carrots / Onions / Garlic / Potatoes	—	—	 Harvest as ready; dry onions and garlic

HERBS

Herb	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
All herbs	—	—	 Full harvest; dry oregano, thyme, rosemary now
Dill / Cilantro seeds	—	—	Save seeds as they dry on plant

FRUITS & BERRIES

Fruit	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Blueberries (peak August)	—	—	 Best month for blueberries
Raspberries / Blackberries / Plums	—	—	 Harvesting continuously
Early Apples / Pears (late Aug)	—	—	 First apples ready; pears soon
Everbearing Strawberries	—	—	 Second crop flush

ROOTS & TUBERS

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Turnips / Radish	—	 Direct sow Wk 1-2 for fall	—
Potatoes / Carrots / Beets	—	—	 Harvest and store

LEGUMES & GRAINS

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Beans (full harvest)	—	—	 Leave some pods to dry for seed/storage
Edamame	—	—	 Harvest late Aug when pods are plump
Sunflower / Corn	—	—	 Sunflower heads mature; corn harvest late Aug

PERENNIAL EDIBLES

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Artichoke	—	—	 Second flush of heads
Rhubarb / Asparagus	—	—	Resting; asparagus fern — leave standing

August Monthly Tips

- ✓ Cure onions and garlic in a warm, dry, airy location for 2-3 weeks before storing — this prevents rot in storage.
- ✓ Freeze or can tomato surplus now. Freeze beans by blanching 2 min, cool in ice water, pat dry, and freeze in bags.

LEGEND:



Indoor Sow



Direct Sow Outdoors

|



Transplant

|



Harvest

|



Bloom

|



Frost Risk

|



Prune/Deadhead

|



Plant Bulb/Tuber

|



Overwinter/Mulch

AUGUST

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ANNUAL FLOWERS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Zinnia / Cosmos / Marigold / Cleome / Nicotiana	—	—	 Peak late summer; deadhead aggressively ☼
Calendula / Pansy / Wallflower (for autumn)	—	 Sow now for autumn/spring display	—

HARDY PERENNIALS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Rudbeckia / Echinacea / Helenium / Solidago	—	—	 Late summer gold and amber tones
Sedum 'Autumn Joy' / Anemone japonica	—	—	 Beginning to bloom late Aug
Early-summer perennials (Geranium, Salvia)	—	—	☼ Cut back after bloom to encourage rebloom

BULBS & CORMS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Dahlia	—	—	 Peak bloom —

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Gladiolus / Crocosmia (Montbretia)	—	—	stunning display  Both blooming vigorously
Spring bulbs (Tulip, Daffodil, Allium)	—	—	Order now for delivery Sept-Oct

SHRUBS & TREES (Ornamental)

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Hydrangea (all types) / Roses (second flush) / Fuchsia	—	—	 Late summer shrub peak
Roses	—	—	✂ Deadhead; do NOT feed after Aug
Wisteria	—	—	✂ Second summer prune (Aug); cut to 5 leaves
Hydrangea	—	—	Do NOT prune now — wait until spring

CLIMBING VINES

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Clematis viticella / Passion Flower / Morning Glory	—	—	 All in full spectacular bloom

BC NATIVE PLANTS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Fireweed / Pearly Everlasting / Goldenrod	—	—	 Late summer native bloom; excellent for bees
Oregon Grape berries	—	—	Ripe berries — good for jam

CUT FLOWERS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Dahlia / Zinnia / Sunflower / Rudbeckia / Echinacea / Solidago / Crocosmia / Gladiolus	—	—	 Superb cut flower month; harvest mornings


August Monthly Tips

- ✓ Allow some annual flowers to set seed for self-seeding next year — Calendula, Cosmos, Nigella, and Larkspur all self-seed reliably.
- ✓ Take cuttings of tender perennials (Fuchsia, Osteospermum, Pelargonium) now before first frost — root in gritty compost indoors.

LEGEND:



Indoor Sow

|



Direct Sow Outdoors

|



→



Transplant

|



Harvest

|



Bloom



Frost Risk



Prune/Deadhead



Plant Bulb/Tuber



Overwinter/Mulch

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SEPTEMBER

PAGE A · EDIBLE CROPS

VEGETABLES

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Winter Lettuce / Mâche / Corn Salad	—	 Direct sow under cover Wk 1-2	—
Spinach / Pak Choi / Arugula	—	 Direct sow Wk 1-3	—
Asian Greens / Claytonia	—	 Direct sow Wk 2-3	—
Broccoli / Kale (starts to protected beds)	—	  Transplant Wk 1-2	—
Tomatoes (last push)	—	—	 Last push before frost; ripen indoors if needed
Winter Squash / Peppers / Corn / Cucumbers / Eggplant	—	—	 Harvest before frost (squash by end Sep)
Beets / Carrots / Parsnips / Kale / Chard / Leeks	—	—	 Continuing harvest

HERBS

Herb	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Parsley (for spring)	—	 Sow Wk 1	—
Chives / Parsley / Basil (pot up)	Pot up for indoor winter use	—	Basil: last chance — make pesto and freeze

FRUITS & BERRIES

Fruit	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Apples (main season) / Pears / Grapes (late Sep)	—	—	 Main apple harvest; store carefully
Fall Raspberries / Blackberries / Everbearing Strawberries	—	—	 Harvest before first frost

ROOTS & TUBERS

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Overwintering Daikon Radish	—	 Sow Wk 1	—

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Potatoes / Carrots / Beets	—	—	 Lift and store; leave parsnips in ground

LEGUMES & GRAINS

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Shell beans / Runner beans	—	—	 Harvest last beans; shell for drying

PERENNIAL EDIBLES

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Garlic	—	 Plant Wk 3-4 (ideal window)	—
Rhubarb crowns (new)	—	Divide and replant now	—
Asparagus crowns	—	Plant Sept-Oct	—

September Monthly Tips

- ✓ Bring green tomatoes indoors to ripen on the countertop — they will ripen slowly in warmth without the vine.
- ✓ Plant garlic as soon as beds are cleared. September garlic has the best chance to develop a good root system before winter.

LEGEND:



Indoor Sow

|



Direct Sow Outdoors

|



Transplant

|



Harvest

|



Bloom

|



Frost Risk

|



Prune/Deadhead

|



Plant Bulb/Tuber

|



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SEPTEMBER

PAGE B · FLOWERS & ORNAMENTALS

ANNUAL FLOWERS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Zinnia / Cosmos / Marigold / Nasturtium / Dahlia	—	—	 Still blooming; enjoy the last of summer
Cosmos / Calendula / Nigella (self-seeding)	—	—	Do NOT deadhead last flush — let seed fall
Winter Pansy / Wallflower	—	 Sow outdoors Wk 1-2	—

HARDY PERENNIALS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Japanese Anemone / Rudbeckia / Helenium / Sedum	—	—	 Peak autumn perennials
Aster / Tricyrtis (Toad Lily) / Persicaria	—	—	 Beautiful autumn additions
Iris / Daylily / Hosta (early-spring types)	—	 Divide Wk 1-3	—

BULBS & CORMS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Dahlia	—	—	 Peak last flush of bloom
Daffodil / Crocus / Muscari / Allium / Hyacinth	—	 Plant spring bulbs Wk 3-4 (ideal time)	—
Gladiolus corms	—	—	Lift and dry after frost; store frost-free
Tulips	—	 Order now; plant late Oct-Nov	—

SHRUBS & TREES (Ornamental)

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Hydrangea / Caryopteris / Perovskia / late Roses	—	—	 Beautiful autumn colour
Roses / shrubs (general)	—	—	Do NOT prune — leave until spring
Tender shrubs (Agapanthus, Crocosmia)	—	—	 Begin mulching crowns with straw

CLIMBING VINES

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
All climbers	—	—	Cut only excessively long shoots — no hard prune. Collect seed pods.

BC NATIVE PLANTS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Aster subspicatus / Goldenrod	—	—	 Autumn native bloom
Snowberry (Symphoricarpos)	—	—	White berries forming — leave for birds

CUT FLOWERS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Dahlia / Zinnia / Rudbeckia / Japanese Anemone / Aster / Sedum	—	—	 Last season for fresh cutting; harvest daily
Strawflower / Statice / Pearly Everlasting	—	—	Dry everlastings now for winter arrangements


September Monthly Tips

- ✓ Take dahlia cuttings or begin lifting tubers after the first hard frost — dry for 2 weeks, then store in cool, frost-free location.
- ✓ Leave ornamental grasses standing through winter — they provide structure, wildlife habitat, and frost-sparkle beauty.

LEGEND:



Indoor Sow

|



Direct Sow Outdoors

|



→



Transplant

|



Harvest

|



Bloom

|



Frost Risk

|



Prune/Deadhead

|



Plant Bulb/Tuber

|



Overwinter/Mulch

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FIRST FROST ~OCTOBER 15 — Protect tender crops with fleece or cloches.
Harvest all frost-tender crops before hard frost. Zone 8a mild but frosts arrive.

OCTOBER

PAGE A • EDIBLE CROPS

VEGETABLES

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Mâche / Claytonia / Winter Spinach	—	 Direct sow under cloche Wk 1-2	—
Overwintering Onion sets	—	 Direct sow Wk 1-2	—
Overwintering Brassicas	—	 Transplant under cover	—
Winter Squash *	—	—	 Harvest ALL before mid-Oct
Peppers / Tomatoes (green)	—	—	 Last harvest; ripen tomatoes indoors
Beets / Carrots / Parsnips	—	—	 Harvest; store in damp sand
Leeks / Kale / Chard / Brussels Sprouts / Turnips / Celeriac	—	—	 Continue harvesting; improve with frost

HERBS

Herb	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Rosemary (exposed sites)	—	—	 Mulch base if in exposed location *
Parsley / Chives	Pot up for indoor windowsill	—	Harvest last Basil; make pesto and freeze

FRUITS & BERRIES

Fruit	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Apples (late) / Pears / Quince	—	—	 Last harvest; store in cool dark place
Hazelnut / Walnut	—	—	 Harvest from ground after drop

ROOTS & TUBERS

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Garlic	—	 Plant Wk 1-3 (last good window)	—
Parsnips	—	—	 Leave some in ground — frost sweetens them
Carrots / Beets	—	—	 Harvest and store in damp sand

PERENNIAL EDIBLES

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Asparagus	—	—	 Mulch with straw Wk 3-4
Artichoke crowns	—	—	 Mulch deeply — borderline hardy *
Rhubarb	—	Divide Wk 1-2	—

October Monthly Tips

- ✓ Add all spent vegetable plants to the compost heap — except any diseased material, which should be binned.
- ✓ October is an excellent time to deep-dig empty beds. Turn in 10cm of compost and let winter rain and frost break it down.

LEGEND:



Indoor Sow

|



Direct Sow Outdoors

|



Transplant

|



Harvest

|



Bloom

|



Frost Risk

|



Prune/Deadhead

|



Plant Bulb/Tuber

|



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FROST RISK — October. First frost ~Oct 15. Remove frost-killed annuals. Plant spring bulbs. Mulch tender plants before hard frost.

OCTOBER

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ANNUAL FLOWERS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
All annuals	—	—	* Remove frost-killed annuals; compost healthy material. Leave self-seeder seeds on soil.

HARDY PERENNIALS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Japanese Anemone / Aster / Sedum / Schizostylis	—	—	 Fading; leave stems for winter interest
Agapanthus / Crocosmia / Gunnera	—	—	 Mulch crowns with straw — borderline hardy

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
			✳

BULBS & CORMS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Daffodil / Hyacinth / Allium / Crocus / Muscari	—	 Plant Wk 1-3	—
Tulips	—	 Plant Wk 3-4 (late planting reduces tulip fire)	—
Dahlias	—	—	Lift after first hard frost; dry 2 wks; store cool
Gladiolus corms	—	—	Dry and store frost-free if not done in Sep

SHRUBS & TREES (Ornamental)

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
New deciduous shrubs and trees	—	Plant Oct-Nov (ideal planting time)	—
Borderline-hardy shrubs (Ceanothus, Abutilon)	—	—	 Mulch base deeply; do NOT prune roses

CLIMBING VINES

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
All climbers	—	—	Tidy rose ties. Do NOT prune Wisteria or Clematis now.

BC NATIVE PLANTS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Snowberry / Highbush Cranberry / Red Osier	—	—	Berries for birds; leave all native structure standing

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Dogwood			

CUT FLOWERS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Rudbeckia / Sedum / Schizostylis / Ornamental grasses	—	—	 Last cuttable flowers of the season

October Monthly Tips

- ✓ Zone 8a's mild winters make October–November the ideal time to plant new shrubs and trees — roots establish over winter in unfrozen soil.
- ✓ Plant spring bulbs generously now — they cost little and pay back handsomely. Layer tulips deep (20cm), daffodils at 15cm.

LEGEND:



Indoor Sow

|



Direct Sow Outdoors

|



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Transplant

|



Harvest

|



Bloom

|



Frost Risk

|



Prune/Deadhead

|



Plant Bulb/Tuber

|



Overwinter/Mulch



FROST RISK — November. Ongoing frost. Protected growing only for tender crops. Mild spells allow some outdoor work.

NOVEMBER

PAGE A • EDIBLE CROPS

VEGETABLES

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Leeks	—	—	 Continue harvesting through winter
Brussels Sprouts	—	—	 Better after frost — sweeter flavour
Kale / Chard / Mâche	—	—	 Excellent cold-hardy crops
Winter Spinach / Claytonia / Overwintering Lettuce	—	—	 Harvest under cover only *
Parsnips / Turnips / Celeriac	—	—	 Harvest or leave mulched in ground
<i>No outdoor sowing this month. Maintain row covers and cloches. Check for slug damage under covers.</i>			

HERBS

Herb	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Parsley / Chives / Rosemary	—	—	 Harvest from protected plants
Sage / Thyme	—	—	 Light harvest; thyme: mulch crowns in exposed sites

FRUITS & BERRIES

Fruit	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Stored apples / pears	—	—	🍂 Check monthly; remove any rotting fruit
Bare-root fruit trees / canes	—	Plant Nov-Feb (ideal)	—
Currants / Gooseberries	—	—	✂️ Prune Nov-Feb while dormant

ROOTS & TUBERS

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Parsnips / Carrots / Beets	—	—	🍂 Harvest from storage or mulched ground
Celeriac	—	—	🍂 Harvest as needed from ground

LEGUMES & GRAINS

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
All legumes & grains	—	—	Nothing to sow or harvest this month

PERENNIAL EDIBLES

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Asparagus	—	—	🌲 Mulch with straw; leave ferns standing
Rhubarb	—	—	Dormant; do not disturb
Artichoke	—	—	🌲 Crowns mulched with straw ✂️
Garlic (last call)	—	🍅 Plant Wk 1 if not yet done	—

 November Monthly Tips

- ✓ Order seed catalogues for next season — begin planning crop rotations on paper. Note what worked and what didn't this year.
- ✓ Deep-dig and compost-mulch empty beds now. Add 10cm of compost as a winter mulch — let frost and worms do the work.

LEGEND:



Indoor Sow



Direct Sow Outdoors



Transplant



Harvest



Bloom





Frost Risk



Prune/Deadhead



Plant Bulb/Tuber



Overwinter/Mulch

Errington, BC · Zone 8a · Central Vancouver Island

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FROST RISK — November. Garden quietens. Winter-blooming shrubs begin. Leave perennial stems for wildlife and winter interest.

NOVEMBER

PAGE B · FLOWERS & ORNAMENTALS

ANNUAL FLOWERS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
All annuals	—	—	None. Clean beds. Mulch annual beds for spring.

HARDY PERENNIALS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Hellebores (Lenten Rose)	—	—	 May begin blooming late Nov *
Schizostylis (Kaffir Lily)	—	—	 Fading last blooms
Most perennials	—	—	Leave all stems standing — winter interest and insect habitat

BULBS & CORMS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Daffodil / Crocus / Allium / Muscari / Tulips	—	 Last chance to plant Wk 1-2	All dormant underground *
Stored Dahlia tubers / Gladiolus corms	—	—	Check stored bulbs for rot; remove soft areas

SHRUBS & TREES (Ornamental)

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Viburnum bodnantense 'Dawn'	—	—	 Beginning to bloom — beautifully fragrant *
Mahonia 'Charity'	—	—	 Beginning to bloom — bold yellow spikes
New bare-root deciduous shrubs and trees	—	Plant Nov-Mar (ideal)	—
Tender shrubs (Ceanothus, Myrtle)	—	—	 Mulch base protection *

CLIMBING VINES

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
All climbers	—	—	Clean up dead annual vines. Secure permanent vine supports for winter storms.

BC NATIVE PLANTS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Snowberry (white berries) / Red Osier Dogwood (red stems)	—	—	Excellent winter structure and bird food; leave all in place

CUT FLOWERS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Viburnum / Mahonia stems / Holly berries	—	—	 For fragrant indoor arrangements
Dried everlastings (Strawflower, Statice)	—	—	Use dried flower store from summer

November Monthly Tips

- ✓ Clean and lightly oil all pruning tools, spades, and forks before winter storage — this prevents rust and extends tool life.
- ✓ Begin cold stratification of any seeds requiring it (many natives and woodland plants need 8-12 weeks in damp cold to germinate).

LEGEND:



Indoor Sow

|



Direct Sow Outdoors

|



Transplant

|



Harvest

|



Bloom

|



Frost Risk

|



Prune/Deadhead

|



Plant Bulb/Tuber

|



Overwinter/Mulch

Errington, BC · Zone 8a · Central Vancouver Island

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FROST RISK — December. Coldest month. Protect all growing crops. Check cloches and row covers regularly. Mild spells allow brief garden work.

DECEMBER

PAGE A · EDIBLE CROPS

VEGETABLES

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Kale	—	—	 Excellent after frost — sweetened by cold
Brussels Sprouts	—	—	 Best now — frost improves flavour greatly
Leeks / Chard (under cover)	—	—	 Harvest as needed *
Mâche / Claytonia / Winter Spinach (under cover)	—	—	 Harvest under glass or polytunnel
Parsnips	—	—	 Very sweet now — best after hard frost
Turnips	—	—	 Harvest as needed

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
			from ground
<i>Remove cloches and row covers during mild spells to allow airflow and prevent fungal disease.</i>			

HERBS

Herb	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Parsley (under cover / mild spots)	—	—	 Harvest lightly *
Rosemary / Sage / Thyme	—	—	 Frost-hardy; harvest in mild spells
Other herbs	—	—	Dormant — use stored/frozen summer herbs

FRUITS & BERRIES

Fruit	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Stored apples / pears	—	—	 Check; remove any rot
Bare-root trees and canes	—	Plant in mild spells Dec-Feb	—
Apple / Pear	—	—	 Dormant pruning Dec-Feb (no disease risk)

ROOTS & TUBERS

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Parsnips / Carrots / Beets / Celeriac	—	—	 Harvest from storage or mulched ground
Garlic (overwintering)	—	—	Overwintering underground — nothing to do *

LEGUMES & GRAINS

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
All legumes & grains	—	—	Nothing to sow or harvest — plan next year's rotation

PERENNIAL EDIBLES

Crop	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Harvest / Action
Rhubarb	—	—	Fully dormant. Force under upturned pot for Jan/Feb harvest.
Asparagus	—	—	Fully dormant with straw mulch ✱

December Monthly Tips

- ✓ Plan next year's garden layout now — rotate brassicas, legumes, roots, and alliums to different beds to prevent disease build-up.
- ✓ Order seeds now for the best selection. Force Witloof chicory indoors in sand for winter salad leaves.

LEGEND:



Indoor Sow

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Direct Sow Outdoors

|



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Transplant

|



Harvest

|



Bloom

|



Frost Risk

|



Prune/Deadhead

|



Plant Bulb/Tuber

|



Overwinter/Mulch



FROST RISK — December. Midwinter. Winter-blooming shrubs at their glorious best. The garden rests and renews.

DECEMBER

PAGE B • FLOWERS & ORNAMENTALS

ANNUAL FLOWERS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
All annuals	—	—	None. Beds resting. Appreciate the quiet season.

HARDY PERENNIALS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Helleborus niger (Christmas Rose)	—	—	 Blooming magnificently *
Euphorbia amygdaloides var. robbiae	—	—	Evergreen; architectural interest year-round
All perennial stems	—	—	Leave all stems standing — insect overwintering habitat

BULBS & CORMS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Spring bulbs (all) outdoors	—	—	Dormant underground * — spring magic to come

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Forced Hyacinth / Paperwhite Narcissus / Amaryllis (indoors)	—	—	 Glorious Christmas blooms indoors — fragrant

SHRUBS & TREES (Ornamental)

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Viburnum bodnantense 'Dawn'	—	—	 Fragrant mid-winter bloom — outstanding
Mahonia (all types)	—	—	 Peak bloom — bold yellow, sweetly fragrant
Witch Hazel (Hamamelis)	—	—	Buds swelling; first spidery blooms soon
Garrya elliptica	—	—	Silver catkins emerging — beautiful winter display
Wintersweet (Chimonanthus)	—	—	 If established — exquisite fragrance *

CLIMBING VINES

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
All climbers	—	—	Dormant. Check and tighten ties and supports during winter storms.

BC NATIVE PLANTS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Red Osier Dogwood	—	—	Brilliant red stems — outstanding winter interest
Holly / Evergreen Huckleberry (Vaccinium ovatum)	—	—	Berries for wildlife; glossy evergreen leaves

CUT FLOWERS

Plant	 Indoor Sow	 Direct Sow / Transplant	 Bloom / Action
Forced Amaryllis / Paperwhite / Hyacinth (indoors)	—	—	 Stunning Christmas bloom displays
Holly / Mahonia / Garrya / Viburnum (stems)	—	—	Winter arrangements — architectural and fragrant
Dried Hydrangea heads / Rosemary / Conifer sprigs	—	—	Festive arrangements and wreaths

December Monthly Tips — & A Year-End Note

- ✓ Add evergreen boughs as mulch on tender plants — this provides insulation and reduces frost penetration around crowns.
- ✓ Gift a pot of forced bulbs or an Amaryllis to a fellow gardener. Rest, plan, and look forward — January seed catalogues are just around the corner!

 **Thank you for gardening in beautiful Errington, BC.** *This calendar is calibrated to Zone 8a's generous climate — enjoy every season of your garden. Happy growing, Jarin!*

LEGEND:



Indoor Sow

|



Direct Sow Outdoors

|



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Transplant

|



Harvest



Bloom



Frost Risk



Prune/Deadhead



Plant Bulb/Tuber



Overwinter/Mulch